

Nathalie Maldonado

Oceanside, CA | 442-288-5627 | nathaliemaldonado04@gmail.com
[linkedin.com/in/nathalie-maldonado](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nathalie-maldonado) | nathaliemaldonado.github.io

SUMMARY

Business Psychology graduate in consumer insights and market research. Has fielded a 500+ respondent willingness-to-pay survey and classified a 57,000-post consumer corpus into complaint themes that became a recommendation for brand leadership. Pairs survey design, segmentation, and competitive benchmarking with R, SQL, and LLM-based text classification. Fluent in Spanish and English.

EDUCATION

University of California San Diego — La Jolla, CA

June 2026

Bachelor of Science in Business Psychology

Coursework: Applied Market Research • Business Analytics • Data Science with AI • Product Marketing & Management

SKILLS

Consumer Research: Survey design, customer segmentation, willingness-to-pay measurement, competitive benchmarking, SWOT analysis, positioning, large-scale qualitative coding

Measurement & Experimentation: A/B testing, difference-in-differences, regression discontinuity, synthetic control, heterogeneous treatment effects, permutation inference, bias auditing

Data, Tools & AI: R (tidyverse, httr2), SQL, Qualtrics, Quarto, Git / GitHub Pages, Google Workspace; LLM API integration with JSON-schema structured outputs and cost-optimized retry pipelines

Languages: Spanish (fluent), English (fluent)

RESEARCH & ANALYTICS PROJECTS

Consumer Complaint Classification at Scale — Coca-Cola Zero Reformulation

Jun 2026

Data Science with AI • UC San Diego

- Classified 57,000+ consumer posts into 16 complaint categories with an R and LLM API pipeline using JSON-schema enforced outputs and retry logic — replacing a hand-coding task of roughly 950 analyst-hours.
- Measured complaint-volume shifts around the 2017 and 2021 formula changes using event-study difference-in-differences, delivered as a one-page recommendation written for brand leadership rather than analysts.

Ergonomic Pen Concept — End-to-End Market Research (Penguin Pen)

2025

Applied Market Research • UC San Diego • Conducted for an early-stage consumer product concept

- Fielded a 500+ respondent Qualtrics survey measuring feature preference and willingness to pay inside a \$17.5B global writing-instrument market, benchmarked against BIC, Pilot, and Paper Mate.
- Segmented respondents across demographic, psychographic, and occupational dimensions, then converted the findings into a SWOT, a segmentation map, and the positioning statement “Precision Meets Comfort.”

Causal Evaluation of a Crisis-Response Program — Denver STAR

Apr 2026

Business Analytics • UC San Diego • Team of 3

- Estimated the causal effect of dispatching mental-health clinicians instead of police on low-level offense rates across 386,865 incident records, 78 neighborhoods, and 44 months.
- Separated 8 treated neighborhoods from 70 controls and modeled COVID-19 trends explicitly so the pandemic shock could not be misread as program effect; peer-reviewed across UC San Diego Rady and Northwestern Kellogg.

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Research & Data Support — Independent • Oceanside / La Jolla, CA

2022 – 2025

- Built and verified a prospect list of 100+ companies — sourcing firmographic and contact records, deduplicating entries, and validating them for outreach use.

Keyboard Repair & Customization Service — La Jolla, CA

Oct 2022 – Apr 2024

Founder & Sole Operator

- Grew a referral-only repair service to 25+ clients across two academic years with zero advertising spend.
- Quoted parts cost and turnaround before every job, then held same-week delivery across concurrent repairs.
- Sourced parts, set per-job pricing, and managed inventory and scheduling alongside a full course load.

Oceanside Public Library Foundation — Oceanside, CA

Aug 2021 – Nov 2021; Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

Library Intern • Returned for a second term

- Ran daily logistics for a youth summer program spanning multiple age groups, preparing activities and supplies so every session opened on schedule.
- Maintained food distribution records and served as Spanish-English translator for visiting families, opening library programming to Spanish-speaking patrons who could not otherwise access it.
- Designed teen programming with the intern team and prepared the HUB infant-and-mother resource space for public reopening.

Childcare & Tutoring — Private families, Oceanside, CA • 2022–2025 (academic terms), recurring paid work with repeat families.